

	DOCUMENT NAME	INTERNAL AUDIT CHECKLIST (AQB)				
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AUDIT CHECKLIST (AQB)

REQUIREMENTS FOR BINDT AUTHORISED QUALIFYING BODIES

4.2 Quality Management System			
4.2.1 QMS - General			
4.2.1.1	The organisation shall implement and maintain a fully documented quality management system which is certified and fully conforms to ISO 9001 and/or AS 9100; this certification must be issued by a body holding ISO 17021 approval granted by a national accreditation body affiliated with International Accreditation Forum (IAF).		
4.2.1.2	The purpose of the QMS section within this document is to detail the how Organisation's QMS is implemented and applied specifically to the PCN Examination process and to allow for BINDT to confirm, during scheduled assessments, that the Organisation's training process maintains compliance with BINDT requirements as related to ISO9001 (current version).		
4.2.1.3	The QMS shall comprise of a Quality Manual and Quality Procedures (and Work Instructions where necessary) that is compliant with the latest edition of ISO 9001. Documented procedures shall cover quality management and product realisation processes. The management system shall be controlled and periodically reviewed according to the stipulations in the Training Organisation's quality manual. <i>NOTE 1: Although the 2015 version of ISO9001 has removed the requirement for some mandatory documents (including a quality manual) BINDT still expects Training Organisations to have suitable documented systems, processes, and records to enable the BINDT assessment program to be able to confirm compliance with the requirements of this document.</i> <i>NOTE 2: An exclusion for design and development can no longer be claimed as Training Organisations design and develop training materials</i>		
4.2.1.4	The AQB shall establish and maintain a procedure to control all documents essential to the provision of an AQB service, e.g., PCN documents, quality management system, applicable standards and specifications.		

4.2.1.5	AQB management shall ensure that affected personnel are aware when change has occurred within the QMS and shall also ensure that all necessary technical and procedural data is available to enable staff to comply with requirements.		
4.2.1.6	The AQB shall devise all necessary procedures for the adequate control of PCN examinations for which it is authorised and shall ensure that such procedures are implemented by all appropriate staff.		
4.2.1.7	The QMS shall available be in the English language. Current up-to-date versions of QMS documents shall be provided to BINDT, or its agents, upon request. This is normally to BINDT Lead Assessors during the audit preparation process. Failure to supply QMS documents to BINDT Lead Assessors, in good time, could lead to cancellation of scheduled assessments with the training Organisation being liable for any costs already incurred		
4.2.1.8	Should major changes occur in Approved Training Organisation policy, personnel, documentation, facilities, or operating procedure, which may affect the validity of approval, the British Institute of Non-Destructive Testing shall be informed, immediately. Failure to do so may result in suspension or withdrawal of approval, or a refusal to renew approval.		
4.2.2 QMS – Management Review			
4.2.2.1	Authorised Qualifying Bodies (AQB) shall conduct a management review related to its training (and examination, where applicable) processes on a minimum of an annual basis. The management review shall be documented and available for review during BINDT assessments		
4.2.2.2	Where the Authorised Qualifying Body is part of a larger parent Organisation then any top-tier management review must include reference to the review of the examination processes. Alternatively, a separate management review just for the AQB section of the parent Company is advised		
4.2.2.3	The management review agenda shall follow, as a minimum, the inputs and outputs as detailed in ISO9001:2015 section 9.3.		
4.2.2.4	Management review inputs a) The status of actions from previous management reviews. b) Changes in external and internal issues that are relevant to the quality management system. c) Information on <u>THE PERFORMANCE AND EFFECTIVENESS</u> of the quality management system, including trends in: • Customer satisfaction and feedback from relevant interested parties. • The extent to which quality objectives have been met.		

	• Process performance and conformity of products and services. Related to the outcome of Measurement, Analysis, and Improvement processes. • Nonconformities and corrective actions. • Monitoring and measurement results. • Audit results. • The performance of external providers. d) The adequacy of resources. e) The effectiveness of actions taken to address risks and opportunities. f) Opportunities for improvement.		
4.2.2.5	Management review outputs a) The outputs of the management review shall include decisions and actions related to: • Opportunities for improvement. • Any need for changes to the quality management system. • Resource needs.		
4.2.3 QMS – Internal Audit			
4.2.3.1	The AQB quality management system shall include a documented schedule for internal audit which will cover the whole of the quality management system and examination processes (including AECs and RECs where applicable) at least once in each calendar year. The internal audit program may consist of a series of audits addressing individual aspects of the QMS and examination process or may consist of a single audit that encompasses all aspects of the QMS and examination process.		
4.2.3.2	The AQB shall have a procedure/process for the conduct of internal audit. The AQB shall retain documented internal audit records which shall include, as a minimum, an audit report and reference to the objective evidence reviewed during the audit. Any nonconformances and/or observations (Opportunities for improvement) shall also be clearly documented.		
4.2.4 QMS – Complaints & Appeals			
4.2.4.1	BINDT implements a process to deal with complaints from examination candidates and/or employers of examination candidates, and AQB status may be suspended or withdrawn at any time if, upon investigation, non-conformances are judged by the Certification Panel to warrant it		
4.2.4.2	A system to record and resolve any complaints received shall be operated by the AQB and complaint records shall be available for review during BINDT audit(s).		
4.2.5 QMS – Corrective Action			
4.2.5.1	The AQB shall have a procedure/process for corrective action. The corrective action process may be applied to resolve audit		

	findings/observations, complaints received and any other issue that the AQB deems the process to be appropriate.		
4.2.5.2	All instances where the corrective action process is implemented shall be documented and shall be available for review during BINDT audit(s).		
4.2.6 QMS – Measurement, Analysis, and Improvement			
4.2.6.1	In addition to the requirements of ISO 9001, AQB management shall: a) Evaluate processes associated with the administering of examinations, ensuring that they are delivered in an effective manner which meets the customer's requirements. b) Monitor and measure customer and/or candidate satisfaction. Collect and analyse any relevant data related to determining the overall quality of the training process		
4.2.6.2	The above activities will provide data which shall be collated and analysed in order to identify trends and/or improvements to management systems and processes		
4.2.6.3	AQB management shall implement and monitor improvements, reporting the status of improvement strategies at Management Review		
4.2.7 QMS – Resource Management			
4.2.7.1	AQB management shall: a) Ensure that there is adequate staff provision available in all areas of the Examination process. b) Determine the necessary competence for personnel performing work affecting the quality of NDT Examinations. c) Ensure the adequacy of equipment and facilities needed by the business to administer NDT Examinations in the inspection methods for which it is approved or seeking approval. d) Ensure that the working and Examination environment meets Statutory, Regulatory, BINDT and Customer requirements. e) Take all adequate safety precautions to protect staff and candidates. If in the opinion of the appointed lead assessor the organisation has failed to take adequate precautions, BINDT reserves the right to withhold or suspend AQB status until it is satisfied that the unsafe situation has been redressed.		
4.2.8 QMS – Service Realisation			
4.2.8.1	AQB management shall plan service realisation from the point where the customer applies for examination through to the issue of examination results notices Management shall identify key processes and how these processes interact with one another.		
4.2.9 QMS – Control of Records			
4.2.9.1	The AQB shall maintain for at least 11 years comprehensive records as evidence of compliance with these requirements. Such		

	records shall include, but not be limited to, results of: • Continuous monitoring and internal audit. • Staff re-appraisal. • Equipment maintenance reviews and recalibration. • Periodic reviews of marking schemes, procedures and documentation.		
4.2.9.2	The AQB shall also maintain comprehensive examination records (including precise details of which questions each candidate was set for each initial examination and re-examination) in secure lockable storage. Examination records shall normally be retained for a period of 11 years but, in any case, shall not be disposed of without prior consultation with BINDT.		
4.2.9.3	All records shall be available for scrutiny by authorised BINDT representatives		
4.2.9.4	In the event that an AQB ceases trading, or where authority to conduct PCN examinations is relinquished or withdrawn, all PCN examination records shall become the property of BINDT and shall be conveyed promptly and securely to a location specified by BINDT at the expense of the AQB concerned.		
4.2.9.5	Records may be in the form of any type of media, such as hard copy or electronic media. Where the AQB implements a process of retaining scanned examination records, there shall be a process for ensuring that the scanning process is conducted in a controlled and systematic manner in order to provide a consistency within the examination records. This is deemed to be key in ensuring traceability and in facilitating the conduct of BINDT assessments at the AQB.		
5. Resource Management			
5.1.1 AQB Staff - General			
5.1.1.1	The AQB shall ensure adequate resource provision to ensure that the examination process can be effectively and consistently administered at all times. The PCN Coordinator shall inform BINDT of any change in infrastructure, human or other resource that may affect the ability of the AQB to comply with the requirements of this specification or that may have an effect on its ability to operate in accordance with its scope of approval.		

5.1.1.2	The AQB shall appoint a PCN Coordinator who shall be responsible for the overall management of the Examination operations. The primary function of the PCN Coordinator is to ensure that the AQB at all times complies with the requirements of BINDT and that the AQB evolves and implements appropriate systems and procedures so as to ensure the consistency of PCN examination standards. The PCN Coordinator shall be the primary contact between the AQB and PCN. Being the PCN Coordinator does not preclude the individual from holding another appointment within the organisation.		
5.1.1.3	The PCN Coordinator shall inform BINDT of any abuse of the PCN Scheme of which he may become aware, as well as AQB non-compliance and corrective action, and any change in infrastructure, human or other resource that may affect the ability of the AQB to comply with the requirements of this specification. All instances of non-compliance with requirements shall be recorded and brought to the attention of BINDT or its appointed assessors.		
5.1.1.4	The AQB shall appoint a Level 3 certificated and technically competent individual as Chief Examiner. The appointee shall be acceptable to BINDT. The Chief Examiner who shall be responsible for the provision of all resources for examination, and for the preparation, conduct and standards of examination. Once approved by BINDT, he post-holder shall be designated Chief Examiner on the AQB's certificate of authorisation.		
5.1.1.5	The AQB may also appoint a Deputy Chief Examiner" who shall also be a Level 3 certificated and technically competent individual acceptable to BINDT. The Deputy Chief Examiner may act on behalf of the Chief Examiner during times of absence or unavailability . The Chief Examiner shall make the appointment in writing detailing the areas where formal authorisation is given. BINDT shall be notified in advance of any Deputy Chief Examiner appointment which must be agreed and ratified by BINDT. The Deputy Chief Examiners name is to be detailed on the BINDT AQB Scope of Approval.		
5.1.1.6	The AQB shall also designate responsible persons (however named) for the setting up and maintaining a Documented Quality Management System satisfying the criteria contained within ISO 9001 and this document.		

5.1.1.7	All staff within the AQB shall be made aware of their specific responsibilities and method of working, which shall be defined by a documented job description for each position within the organisation. Job Descriptions shall also determine the competence requirements for the appointment. Staff shall be allocated job titles in their terms of reference or letters of appointment, which in turn refer them to the Quality Manual and Job Descriptions. The Organisation shall retain documented evidence of personnel acceptance of assigned roles and responsibilities.		
5.1.1.8	The quality manual shall include an organisational chart detailing the structure of roles within the Organisation. There shall also be a system to identify current incumbents of each role within the organisational chart.		
5.1.1.9	The AQB shall have a documented process whereby all staff sign acknowledge to confirm that they have read, understood and are conversant with the Quality Manual and applicable quality documents (however defined). This shall apply to existing, newly drafted or revised quality documents relevant to their position within the organisation. Records of staff acknowledgement shall be retained for audit purposes.		
5.1.1.10	The AQB shall give commitment to the examination process or take other actions to satisfy the competence needs of its staff		
5.1.1.11	The AQB quality management system shall detail the measures, such as delegation of responsibilities for management and administration, or refraining from conducting PCN examinations in the absence of key staff		
5.1.2 AQB Staff - Staff Competence & Training			
5.1.2.1	All AQB staff shall be appropriately trained and qualified for their roles and functions within the organisation.		
5.1.2.2	All examiners shall be certified to level 3 PCN (or other recognised certification) and having proved practical competence at level 2 in the method and sector for which he or she is to conduct, supervise and grade PCN examinations. In addition, the AQB shall ensure that all examiners are trained with regard to BINDT requirements for examiners and in the content and implementation of the AQB's examination procedures and processes, including the use of the AQB marking schemes and the grading of examinations. <i>Note: Level 3 certifications acceptable to BINDT are ISO9712, EN4179 and ASNT. EN4179 is the only acceptable scheme for PCN/AERO examiners. All three need to be accompanied by proven practical experience in the method and sector at level 2 or equivalent. Proven practical experience may include appropriate current or prior level 2 certification or a documented competency assessment in the required methods & sectors conducted at a BINDT ATO independent of the Level 3s employer</i>		

5.1.2.3	All examiners must be approved by BINDT and appear on the AQB scope of approval in the methods, sectors and categories for which they are to act as an examiner. Applications for new examiners shall be made to BINDT accompanied by the required supporting documentation which shall include the following as a minimum: • Letter or email requesting approval and giving summary details. • Proof of experience (current CV) • Copies of relevant certification • Copy of signed PCN24/PSL56 • A minimum of two completed examination marking packs marked by the applicant examiner and checked by the double-marking moderation process by an approved examiner in the same method and sector. The approved examiners marks and name must appear on any resultant results notice. • Evidence of examiner training in accordance with the AQB's own QMS and PCN24/CP09		
5.1.2.4	The AQB shall ensure that all exam invigilators are trained with regard to BINDT requirements for invigilation and the content and implementation of the relevant AQB examination procedures and processes, including the delivery of pre-examination instructions to candidates and the process of overseeing examinations.		
5.1.2.5	In addition, Invigilators of practical examinations shall hold relevant PCN certification (or certification recognised by BINDT), otherwise, the AQB shall demonstrate to the satisfaction of BINDT that the invigilator has received appropriate training in the points to be observed and recorded during practical examinations.		
5.1.2.6	All invigilators must be approved by BINDT and appear on the AQB scope of approval in the methods, sectors and categories for which they are to act as an invigilator. Applications for new invigilators shall be made to BINDT accompanied by the required supporting documentation which shall include the following as a minimum: • Letter or email requesting approval and giving summary details. • Proof of experience (current CV) • Copies of relevant practical certification (Level 2 or above) OR evidence of training in the practical aspects related to the method and techniques relevant to the approval sought. • Copy of signed PCN24/PSL56 • Evidence of invigilator training in accordance with the AQB's own QMS and PCN24/CP09		

	Note: Personnel approved as examiners are automatically approved as invigilators in the methods, sectors and categories for which they are an examiner. They need not appear on the AQB scope as an invigilator. The appearance as an examiner on the AQB scope of approval is sufficient in isolation.		
5.1.2.7	Invigilators, who shall be named as such within the AQB quality documentation and on the AQB approval certificate, are authorised by the AQB's PCN Coordinator and <u>supervised by an examiner</u>. The term supervised, in this context, means that invigilation is effectively controlled by an authorised examiner who is available and contactable by the appointed invigilator at all times when PCN examinations are being conducted. PCN/AERO variance: For PCN/AERO practical examinations the administration/invigilation SHALL be performed by an authorised examiner		
5.1.2.8	The AQB shall retain detailed records of examiner and invigilator training. The records of training and qualifications shall be made available to BINDT or their appointed assessors upon demand		
5.1.3 AQB Staff - Impartiality & Confidentiality			
5.1.3.1	All AQB staff involved in any aspect of the administration or conduct of PCN examinations shall be impartial with respect to candidates and their employers.		
5.1.3.2	All directly employed and contracted persons shall sign a commitment to confidentiality and impartiality in regard of the PCN examination process. Form PCN24/PSL56 shall be used for this purpose. By signing PCN24/PSL56 AQB staff give an undertaking comply with the rules defined in the specific PCN document that applies to their particular role(s) within the PCN Scheme, including those relating to confidentiality and those relating to independence from commercial and other interests, and from any prior and/or present link with the persons to be examined or organisations assessed that would compromise impartiality. The information on this record shall be used as input to identify threats to impartiality. The AQB shall retain the signed forms as staff records. <i>Note: Organisations should monitor updates of PCN24/PSL forms and endeavour to ensure they maintain signed copies of the relevant current versions. This is fundamental to ensure any important changes to PCN24/PSL forms are acknowledged by AQB staff.</i>		
5.1.3.3	All individuals involved in certification matters are required to respect the confidentiality of information to which they are privy by virtue of their position or appointment. Such confidentiality must be respected even in the event that an individual should cease to be so involved.		

5.1.3.4	AQBs shall not directly involve, in PCN examinations, sub-contract examiners or invigilators, or any other sub-contract personnel, where such personnel have access to examination material if their other employment is such as to threaten the impartiality of the examination process or to significantly threaten the security of PCN Scheme examination material.		
5.1.3.5	AQBs shall not conduct examinations for candidates employed by the same organisation that owns the AQB, or who are employed by an organisation having a commercial interest in the AQB including but not limited to the remote examination locations (AECs) managed by the AQB unless measures acceptable to BINDT are in place to ensure impartiality.		
5.1.3.6	Examination staff are required to declare any interest in any candidate in whose examination they are involved in any capacity. An examiner or invigilator is prohibited from direct involvement in any examination of a candidate in whom they may have an interest by virtue of having a common employer, having provided training to that candidate in the preceding 2 years for the examination concerned, or any reason that may actually or potentially threaten impartiality.		
5.1.3.7	Examiners and invigilators are required to sign a PCN24/PSL56A form for each examination in which they have an active role. By signing the PCN24/PSL56A Invigilators and Examiners are confirming compliance with the Impartiality and confidentiality requirements laid down in this section of PCN24/CP09 especially confirming that no conflict of interest exists between themselves and the candidate and that they have not actively participated in training of the candidate within the preceding 2 years in respect of the examination attempted. AQB Organisations should retain a copy of the PCN24/PSL56A form within the applicable exam records and they should be made available during BINDT assessments.		
5.2 Facilities			
5.2.1	AQBs represent the image and reputation of BINDT. Consequently, AQB premises and facilities are expected to present a professional image at all times. Housekeeping and presentation shall remain at the highest level. BINDT retains the right to remove approvals if in the opinion of its agents the premises/facilities reflect badly on the professional image and reputation of BINDT.		
5.2.2	The premises used for examinations shall comply with the latest issue of all relevant national statutory legislation, e.g. in the UK the Health and Safety at Work Act, COSHH Regulations and where applicable, Ionising Radiation Regulations. Where local regulations are non-existent or lax BINDT still expects AQBs to maintain a high ethos and culture in respect of Health and Safety.		

5.2.3	With regard to Radiographic facilities, and irrespective of local legislation, the AQB shall ensure the following safety requirements exist. • Sufficient Radiation warning signage and lights. • Exposure rooms capable of containing the level and type of radiation used. • A physical barrier at the entry to exposure rooms when radiation equipment is activated. • Calibrated Radiation monitoring equipment • TLD/Film badges or calibrated personnel radiation beepers for all students		
5.2.4	Suitable safety notices shall be displayed in appropriate locations accessible to students. Relevant safety data sheets shall be on hand at the point of use of potentially hazardous equipment or processes.		
5.2.5	The AQB must provide quiet examination rooms supplied with all necessary services (heat, power, lighting & separation of candidates etc.). There must be sufficient room to ensure a gap of not less than 1.5 metres between candidates, measured between adjacent shoulders during written examinations.		
5.2.6	Examination invigilators must ascertain that the examination conditions are to the satisfaction of all candidates prior to the commencement of PCN examinations. This includes provisions for acceptable levels of comfort (lighting, temperature etc.). This may be achieved verbally or by the prominent positioning of a notice in the examination room which states that it is the candidate's responsibility to inform the examination invigilator if they feel that the prevailing conditions are such that they may adversely affect the examination result.		
5.2.7	In the event that, following commencement of an examination, conditions deteriorate to a level below that required by BINDT, the examination must be terminated or suspended and not restarted until such time as the conditions are restored to a standard conducive to maintaining the candidate's comfort and concentration and to the conduct of PCN examination.		
5.2.8	Where premises are shared between training and examination, there shall be no joint usage of the facilities, i.e. examinations shall not take place whilst the facilities are being used for training or vice versa.		
5.3 Examination Questions & Papers			

5.3.1	Where BINDT provides a central bank of validated multi-choice examination questions from which centrally issued examination papers are constructed. BINDT has a need to add to or refresh the question data base on a frequent basis especially with regard to emerging methods and technologies. As a consequence, BINDT relies upon the technical knowledge and professionalism of staff at the AQB to assist in the provision of suitable questions or consideration. The BINDT will, periodically, issue formal requests to AQB for the provision of new questions or examination papers. There is a mandatory requirement that AQB respond to such formal requests within one month of receipt. Failure to do so may result in findings being raised during BINDT assessments or even affect the AQB approval status in severe or repeat instances. All questions provided shall subsequently be validated by BINDT and added to the central question bank.		
5.3.2	Where the central question bank does not provide validated questions of sufficient quantity or quality, the AQB is required to hold a minimum of twice the number of examination questions specified for any examination part which it is authorised to conduct, and to provide those questions to BINDT for validation and inclusion in the central bank of questions.		
5.3.3	An AQB shall detail the means of procurement, production and maintenance of up-to-date examination questions for approval by BINDT, including marking schemes for questions and instructions, where the central provision does not presently cover a PCN examination for which the AQB seeks or holds authorisation. Where examination papers are constructed by the AQB, there shall be a documented procedure for ensuring that such examination papers adequately reflect the PCN published examination syllabus and are subject to periodic review and revalidation.		
5.3.4	Once approved for PCN examinations, examination material shall be used for no purpose other than PCN examinations. No questions which have been used for training purposes during the preceding twelve months shall be utilised within PCN examinations. <u>PCN/AERO variance:</u> For PCN/AERO examinations questions used in EN4179 Aerospace Examinations may be used and vice-versa – providing a candidate for both PCN and EN4179 is not given any of the same questions on both papers		
5.3.5	There shall be a documented AQB procedure for a system by which candidate's replies to examination questions are periodically reviewed in order to detect those questions which consistently elicit incorrect answers from candidates. This procedure shall require BINDT to be notified of any such examination questions.		

5.3.6	BINDT issues compiled examination question papers in the English language. Subject to satisfactory arrangements ensuring security, and grammatical and technical accuracy, PCN examination papers may be translated into other languages, but only with the specific consent and written authorisation in each case of BINDT. <u>Additional Requirements for PCN/AERO</u> 1) <i>The PCN/Aerospace approved AQB shall prepare the specific examination papers. The specific examination questions shall be based upon the specifications listed in Appendix 1 of PCN/AERO plus any other specifications/standards advised by the candidate's employer or Responsible Level 3. The AQB shall determine, in consultation with the candidate's employer, whether additional specifications are to be used prior to preparation of the specific examination paper. Where no other specifications/standards are advised the specifications listed in PCN/AERO Appendix 1 shall be used as the default option.</i> 2) <i>The PCN/AERO specific examination questions shall be appropriate to the NDT method and set at a level reflective of the level of certification sought.</i> 3) <i>Specific PCN/AERO questions shall require the candidate to demonstrate understanding of the reference material provided, rather than merely finding the location of the defect. Specific questions may be multi-choice or require narrative answers. Should narrative questions carry more than one mark then the AQB shall have appropriate marking guidance for these questions.</i>		
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5.4 Examination Specimens

5.4.1	The AQB quality management system shall document procedures for the control, procurement, production, maintenance, rotation, disposal and introduction of new examination specimens. BINDT may at any time require AQBs to remove from service a particular specimen, or to obtain or procure and introduce specimens with specific natural or artificial flaws.		
5.4.22	The minimum number of practical specimens to be available for each permanently established examination centre operated by an AQB that will enable the conduct of examinations for a stated maximum number of candidates at any examination sitting is specified in the relevant PCN Method Specific AQB Appendix Documents. Examination specimens shall meet the relevant		

	specification (where one exists) before use in PCN examinations.		
5.4.3	Where a specification does not yet exist for a particular category of examination specimens, the AQB shall provide for BINDT approval a list of specimens proposed for use, including a description of each, and shall not conduct examinations in the category concerned until authorisation has been issued		
5.4.4	Once approved for PCN examinations, examination specimens shall be used for no purpose other than PCN examinations. No specimens which have been used for training purposes during the preceding twelve months shall be utilised within PCN examinations. The Organisation shall maintain record of specimens used in any given practical examination to ensure that the same specimens are not utilised for the same candidate in consecutive examinations. <u>PCN/AERO variance:</u> <i>As approved by BINDT CMC and the UK NANDTB, PCN/AERO practical specimens may be used for EN4179 examinations conducted by a UK NANDTB/BINDT approved Outside Agency and vice-versa. Where candidates attempt both PCN and EN4179 examinations within a two-year period of each other, the Organisation shall maintain record of specimens used in any given practical examination to ensure that the same specimens are not utilised in both the PCN and EN4179 examinations.</i>		
5.4.5	A list of PCN examination specimens and their disposition shall be submitted to BINDT during initial authorisation. This list shall be maintained, updated and controlled by the AQB. During assessment and surveillance visits, BINDT assessors will select specimens at random and audit the specimen and associated master report for compliance within the relevant PCN Appendix documents.		
5.4.6	Each practical specimen shall be uniquely identified by an appropriate permanent marking to ensure that it is completely traceable. Such marking shall not interfere with the practical testing or inspection of the specimen and shall, wherever practicable, be concealed from the candidate whilst the specimen is being used for examination		
5.4.7	There shall be a documented procedure for the production of master reports of flaws in each specimen. The master report shall be based only on the inspection or test method and the particular technique to be applied to the specimen by examination candidates		

5.4.8	All examination specimens, in order to gain BINDT approval, must be evaluated independently by two personnel holding a minimum of PCN Level 2 certification. Where there is significant disagreement between the two evaluations concerning defect content, location and/or characterisation, the exercise shall be repeated until there is agreement in the result. From these separate evaluations, a master report shall be generated and this shall be signed by the AQB Chief Examiner initially and at each periodic review. It is permitted for the Chief Examiner to approve one of the individual test reports as the “master” record providing it contains all the needed (relevant) information need of a master report and it is clearly designated as the “Master record” and is signed as approved by the Chief Examiner. Records of such evaluations shall be maintained for a minimum of ten years beyond the date when the specimen ceases to be used for PCN examinations		
5.4.9	The AQB shall have in place a procedure whereby examination specimen master reports are reviewed by an examiner, initially after between 5 and 10 usages, and thereafter periodically where instances of exam failure attributable to a given specimen raise concern. If more than 50% of candidates fail to correctly report and characterise all mandatory reportable defects in the specimen, it is to be re-evaluated for suitability as a PCN examination specimen.		

5.5 NDT Equipment

5.5.1	The AQB shall hold sufficient relevant test and/or inspection equipment to enable the conduct of PCN examinations for a stated number of candidates at any one practical examination sitting. Minimum equipment holdings for AQBs are detailed in Appendix 2. Details/records of designated examination equipment shall be maintained by the AQB and made available to BINDT or its agents upon request. <i>Note: PCN24/CP08B checklist for NDT equipment is equally applicable to ATO and AQ assessments.</i>		
5.5.2	The AQB shall immediately notify BINDT should a significant change in equipment resource occur that may have an effect on the AQB scope of approval.		
5.5.3	The AQB shall, as far as practicable, maintain all such equipment in a serviceable condition and provide for its maintenance and overhaul as necessary. The AQB must be able to demonstrate all processes/techniques for any given NDT method within their AQB scope of approval.		
5.5.4	The AQB shall maintain a fully documented system for the maintenance and calibration of NDT Equipment. Internal verification of equipment against reference standards, or internal process checking using documented procedures/work instructions, is acceptable in determining the performance and suitability of		

	NDT equipment. Internal verifications and process checks shall be conducted at planned intervals by AQB staff. Internal verifications and process checks shall be recorded and the records retained for audit purposes. <i>Note: With regard to equipment used for examination purposes, the AQB is expected to meet the requirements above. However, the calibrations conducted do not necessarily need to be traceable to National Standards except where personal safety is affected, i.e., in the case of equipment generating, emitting or monitoring ionizing radiations. Calibrations and/or verifications conducted as part of the examination process may be acceptable providing, they prove the reliability and suitability of the equipment in use and are recorded</i>		
5.6 Consumables			
5.6.1	The AQB shall ensure an adequate supply of all consumable materials necessary for PCN examination requirements. A documented procedure is required to ensure that consumables are properly disposed of strictly in accordance with applicable regulations		
5.6.2	Maintenance of capability for processes involving consumable materials shall be covered by a process control procedure. Processes involving consumables shall be checked using known reference or defective standards. The tests shall be conducted at appropriate intervals that ensure the combination of equipment and consumables are capable of detecting discontinuities associated with the examinations to be conducted. BINDT considers appropriate periods to be monthly or pre-examination, as a minimum. System process checks shall be conducted by AQB staff and shall be recorded		
5.7 Security			
5.7.1	Examination materials, including questions and practical specimens, and information on candidates, require handling with a high degree of security, confidentiality, integrity and impartiality. If data at AQBs are computerised, a documented procedure shall cover, as a minimum, general security, authorisation for access, and measures to prevent loss of hard copy and/or computerised data		
5.7.2	Only authorised personnel from the AQB and BINDT representatives authorised in writing by BINDT shall have access to examination material and records (see PCN24/CP19 - Informal access by third parties).		
5.7.3	Secure lockable storage facilities shall be provided for all examination material including questions, answers, specimens and techniques. These must be located in an area to which candidates do not have unsupervised access. A secure facility for the retention of candidates' records and results shall also be provided.		

5.7.4	Where examination material is stored at a location not under the constant supervision of AQB staff, e.g., at a site remote from any permanently established and staffed examination centre, the AQB shall notify BINDT Certification Services Division management of the location concerned, and the measures in place to safeguard the security and confidentiality of examination material. The AQB shall retain audit records of such locations which include ensuring that security of exam materials is adequately addressed. These audit records (including photographs, if required) shall be retained and made available at BINDT assessments. BINDT reserves the right to audit such storage facilities and to direct that specific additional measures be implemented to safeguard security and confidentiality		
6. PCN Examination Process			
6.1 Candidate Eligibility & Identification			
6.1.1	The AQB shall have a documented procedure for ensuring that all examinations are reported to PCN prior to the examination date. The AQB shall ensure that the reporting of all PCN examinations are submitted to PCN every Friday for the week ahead, using spreadsheet PCN24/PSL6B. This report shall be submitted at least once per week		
6.1.2	The AQB shall have a documented procedure for ensuring that <u>ALL</u> candidates satisfy all requirements, particularly in terms of examination eligibility and identification. The procedure shall detail, but not be limited to, the checking & verification of the following points: • Correctly completed examination application forms (PCN24/PSL57 & PCN24/PSL30) • Evidence of satisfactory completion of a course of training conducted by a BINDT ATO to the relevant PCN syllabus, <i>NOTE: Where additional on-the-job training supplements the approved training, AQBs may accept a signed declaration from the applicant, endorsed by his employer, that this has been carried out, but should implement a system of random checks to verify such statements.</i> • Pre-certification experience (form PCN24/PSL30 shall be used for recording experience), including supervision by an appropriately qualified person. • Annual vision test, where appropriate.(see PCN24/PSL44 for guidance on visual acuity and colour perception requirements). • Identification of the candidate.		

	<i>NOTE: For those candidates already in possession of a centrally issued PCN wallet card or PCN electronic certificate with photograph, AQB's must request sight of one of these as a means of confirming the candidate's identity and authenticity. If a candidate cannot produce formal PCN photographic evidence, then the AQB must either be in a position to offer a passport photograph service or refuse examination until such photographs are supplied and can be attached to a new formal PCN document. Photographs taken at the AQB shall signed by the candidate, for transmission to PCN with the result notice. In the latter case, the AQB must be in a position to witness that the supplied photographs are of the individual attending for examination and must witness the individual signing the reverse of the photographs <u>or</u> must ascertain (using of PCN form PCN24/PSL33) that the signature on the reverse of the photographs is the same individual attending for examination.</i>		
6.1.3	In addition to the mandated eligibility checks detailed above, the AQB shall also have a process to ensure that a minimum of 10% of candidates are subject to verification of the claimed experience and supervision information provided in their application. The AQB shall verify claimed experience by contact with the named supervising person or employer. Records of claimed experience verification checks shall be maintained.		
6.2 Conduct of PCN Examinations			
6.2.1	The AQB shall have in place an operating procedure which ensures that candidates are, at all times during examination, closely supervised by a suitably qualified and authorised examiner or invigilator who shall ensure that no candidate is permitted an unfair advantage or to collude with other candidates. During the written examinations an Invigilator or Examiner must be present at all times and must closely supervise candidates during the practical assessment.		
6.2.2	The AQB quality system shall include a process for invigilation which shall define appropriate training in invigilation techniques including, where necessary, specific points to be noted during practical examinations.		
6.2.3	An invigilator need not be an examiner, but must: • Be approved by BINDT to invigilate the examinations concerned and shall appear as such on the AQB scope of approval. The invigilator		

	shall appropriately certified or trained if invigilating practical examinations. • Trained to deliver pre-examination instructions to candidates and to ensure the completion of the required examination documentation. • Be required to ensure that appropriate examination conditions are maintained at all times. • Ensure that any infringement of examination conditions by any candidate is recorded and reported without delay to the Chief Examiner or PCN Coordinator. • Declare (to the AQB Coordinator or Chief Examiner) any interest in any candidate prior to commencement of an examination.		
6.2.4	Candidates shall sign a non-disclosure agreement or other agreement indicating their commitment not to release confidential examination materials or participate in fraudulent test-taking practices (PCN24/PSL56A). The PCN24/PSL56A form shall also be signed by Invigilators and Examiners thus confirming compliance with the Impartiality, confidentiality and conflict of interest requirements detailed earlier in this document.		
6.2.5	Prior to the commencement of the examination the invigilator shall make all candidates aware of the examination rules and conditions, including the consequences of cheating or collusion. Candidates shall sign a document to confirm their understanding and acceptance of the examination rules and conditions (PCN24/PSL56B). AQB's may use PCN24/PSL56B or a form of their own creation providing that form meets or exceeds all the content of PCN24/PSL56B.		
6.2.6	A PCN examination may be interrupted or curtailed provided, in the opinion of the responsible Examiner or Invigilator, a valid reason exists. In the event of an interrupted or curtailed PCN examination the AQB Coordinator shall advise BINDT in writing of the interruption or curtailment.		
6.2.7	In the event that a PCN examination is suspended or interrupted by the AQB before completion, the candidate shall be permitted to return to complete the examination without further charge at the same AQB within thirty days of the commencement of the original examination.		

6.2.8	Any completed examination parts may be held over pending re-commencement but <u>shall not be marked</u> (and the candidate shall not be given any indication of the result) until such time as all examination parts are completed.		
6.2.9	Any part completed examination papers shall be retained with the candidate's file as an examination record but shall not be considered as a part of the completed examination. In respect of any part not completed, the candidate shall be given an entirely different paper upon re-commencement.		
6.2.10	In the event of a requirement for a re-test examination following the failure in a suspended examination, the earliest date allowable for the re-test shall be calculated from the date of the re-commencement of the suspended examination.		
6.2.11	All staff involved with examinations shall ensure that no examination material is removed by any candidate. This includes any rough notes, sketches etc. that the candidate may have made during the examination.		
6.2.12	The use of programmable calculators is prohibited in PCN examinations, as is the use of personal digital equipment with storage facilities - unless the equipment concerned is inspected by AQB staff before use in an examination to ensure that the candidate is not gaining an unfair advantage, and after use in an examination to ensure the continued security and confidentiality of PCN examination materials.		
6.2.13	There shall be a documented procedure which ensures that all candidates are adequately prepared on the day of the examination. This shall cover, as a minimum, provision of correct examination papers, codes and standards, examination equipment and materials, information on breaks during examination and the consequences of cheating.		
6.2.14	Candidates shall be prohibited from using red ink or correction fluid when completing PCN examination papers. Candidates shall be required to initial beside any corrections they may make on examination papers. In the event that a candidate does use red ink, AQB's should take effective steps to ensure that the responsible examiner's remarks and annotations are made in a manner that does not result in confusion in the event that a PCN moderator or assessor should audit the examination in question.		

6.2.15	Mobile phones and other electronic communications devices are a potential source of cheating and may disturb other candidates if they should be activated during examinations. Consequently, mobile phones and any other electronic communications devices shall be barred from written and practical examination facilities when PCN examinations are being conducted.		
6.2.16	Provided security of examination materials can be guaranteed, candidates may be allowed the use of an AQB provided PC or lap-top computer in the NDT instruction and NDT procedure writing section of the PCN examination. On no account shall the use of a candidate's own computer be permitted during a PCN examination and, for reasons of security, candidates are not permitted to bring any form of computer, including hand-held devices into the examination facilities at a PCN AQB or Examination Centre. The provision of computers for candidate use is optional for any BINDT AQB.		
6.2.17	An extension of up to 25% is authorised in the time allowed in PCN written examinations for candidates suffering from conditions such as dyslexia, or whose first language is not that in which the examination is presented, who are likely to experience difficulty in completing examinations in the published time allowed. AQB's may allow this additional time at their discretion provided a record is retained with the examination records. Arrangements should also be made for an examiner to be present in order to supplement the written examination with oral questions if necessary to establish that the candidate has a firm grasp of the topic being examined.		
6.3 Consistency of PCN Examinations			
6.3.1	The AQB is to make every effort to ensure that its standard of PCN examination(s) is consistent and at all times complies with requirements.		
6.3.2	The AQB shall ensure consistency and veracity of examiners' judgement by implementing a monitoring and moderation process.		
6.3.3	The examination system is to be defined by written procedures which shall include a documented system for moderation of random samples of candidates' examination papers.		
6.3.4	Moderation may take the form of double-marking or cross-verification under the conditions permitted below. <i>Note: The definitions of "Moderation", "Double-marking" and "Cross-verification" are given in section 2 of this document and re-iterated below</i>		

	Moderation: The overall process for checking examination consistency and examiner competence. Double-Marking: A method of moderating and checking examination consistency and examiner competence by the conducting independent secondary marking of an examination and comparing the scrutineer examiner's marks to those awarded by the initial examiner. Cross-Verification: In relation to moderation, a method of checking examination consistency and examiner competence by the reviewing and verifying/validating the original examiner's marking.		
6.3.5	The AQB shall ensure that the moderation process meets the following requirements: A minimum of <u>TWO</u> moderations per examiner per calendar year for each NDT method in which the examiner is authorised on the AQB Scope of Approval. This shall apply to all active examiners on the AQB Scope of Approval. Where exams in specific methods for which the examiner is approved but have not been conducted by the AQB in the preceding calendar year, then the term "each NDT method" in the previous sentence would not apply.		
6.3.6	A minimum of one of the moderations detailed in 6.3.4 above (in each NDT method) shall be achieved by the double-marking method of moderation. The other one may be achieved by either the double-marking or the cross-verification moderation processes.		
6.3.7	The procedure for moderation shall be such that the first examiner is unable to forecast when moderation will occur.		
6.3.8	The AQB shall ensure that non-active examiners remain current with regard to PCN24/CP09 and exam marking practices mandated by PCN and the AQB. Consequently, the AQB shall ensure that non-active examiners are subject to an annual competence test by being required to mark at least one exam per year which shall be subject to moderation by the Chief Examiner or another examiner appointed by the Chief Examiner. Final sign-off on the continued competency of the examiner shall remain the responsibility of the Chief examiner. Failure to comply with this requirement may result in the examiner in question being removed from the AQB scope of Approval (at BINDT discretion).		
6.3.9	Should an examiner be inactive for a period in excess of one year (from the last examination marked by that examiner) the AQB shall have a process to assess that		

	examiners competence prior to his/her reintroduction into the marking process. <i>Note: Activity/inactivity applies to each individual method in which an examiner is approved. For example, if an individual is approved as an examiner in 4 methods (e.g. UT/PT/MT/RT) and has only marked UT/PT/MT over the previous moderation period then he/she shall be deemed inactive in the RT method and the requirements regarding confirmation of competency prior to reintroduction shall apply to the RT method.</i>		
6.3.10	Any identified errors, inconsistencies or moderator disagreement arising from the moderation process shall be reported to the Chief Examiner for investigation. In such instances corrective action shall be taken and the Chief Examiner's decision shall be final. The moderator shall annotate and sign/date the initial examiner's marking sheets. The annotation shall include the outcome of the moderation and any applicable comments.		
6.3.11	Any significant difference between the initial marks awarded and those awarded by the second examiner in the double-marking process shall be investigated and appropriate action taken within the AQB system to restore consistency. In instances of discrepancy, the Chief Examiner's decision shall be final. Both sets of marking records shall be retained by the AQB. <i>Note: BINDT acknowledges that there should be no inconsistency in multiple-choice written examination parts and therefore deems a significant difference in the moderation process to be</i> a) <i>any comparative results from the practical element and/or the written instruction element (where applicable) differing by greater than 5% on either element.</i> b) <i>where an initial "pass" mark becomes a "fail" or vice versa.</i>		
6.3.12	Where major issues are identified that bring the competence of any given examiner into question, that examiner shall be suspended from examination marking pending investigation and appropriate action being taken. Consideration must be given to potential consequences of previous examinations marked. The suspension shall remain in place until remedial training and competence verification takes place. Permanent removal remains an option. The investigation and corrective action process shall be fully documented. The Chief Examiner shall arbitrate and be responsible for the decision-making process. BINDT/PCN shall be advised immediately should this situation arise.		
6.3.13	The AQB shall have a process for recording the examiners against each exam		

	conducted. The process shall allow data analysis to determine the quantity of examinations marked by each examiner in a given period. This process shall also allow BINDT representatives to determine the activity of each examiner on the AQB scope over any given period		
6.3.14	When moderation takes place, it is to be recorded on the candidate's AQB records and on the examination result notice.		
6.3.15	Moderation must take place before the candidate is informed of examination results. Any discrepancy discovered after the results have been sent out shall not be reason to change the "published" result, unless a particular examination result has been investigated in the course of a formal BINDT appeals procedure.		
6.3.16	The procedure shall also include a review of completed examinations for indications of cheating.		
6.3.17	The AQB is to ensure that a candidate is not given the same examination paper or specimen in any subsequent examination he may take. This shall include re-examination and recertification examination(s). <u>PCN/AERO variance:</u> <i>Where candidates attempt both PCN and EN4179 examinations within a two-year period of each other, the Organisation shall maintain record of specimens used in any given practical examination to ensure that the same specimens are not utilised in both the subsequent PCN and EN4179 examinations.</i>		
6.4 Marking & Grading of PCN Examinations			
6.4.1	Generic mandatory marking schemes, for practical examinations, and record sheets for AQB use are available as referenced in PCN24/CP22.		
6.4.2	Generic marking schemes for Level 3 procedure writing and Level 2 Written Instruction writing are available in PCN24/CP25.		
6.4.3	Where PCN24/CP22 does not include a reference to a marking schedule/sheet for a given method or technique, the AQB may formulate their own marking scheme/sheet based upon the principles detailed in the suite of marking schedules within PCN24/CP22. In such cases these shall be prepared by an authorised Examiner, with appropriate certification and shall be approved and signed as approved by the Chief Examiner. Any marking schemes developed in this way shall be submitted to BINDT for future inclusion in PCN24/CP22.		
6.4.4	Marking schedules for all possible solutions are to be produced for all narrative answer questions and are to include key points and marks for answers.		

6.4.5	The conduct of practical examinations shall be defined by written procedures which shall include, observation of the candidate for compliance with safety notes and notices, and selection and correct usage of test equipment		
6.4.6	All examination marking is to be carried out using red ink.		
6.4.7	Examination results notices shall be despatched to the BINDT Certification Records Office, and the candidate not later than 28 days (though it is desirable that this period shall be less than 7 days) from the date of the examination and, in the case of failure in the examination, should include an indication of the reason for failure which is useful to the candidate in preparing for re-examination. The AQB may provide a copy of examination results to the organisation paying the examination fees but must ensure that data is safeguarded as required by national regulations on data protection.		
6.4.8	Failure by the candidate or their sponsor/employer to make payment for any examination within 12 months of the examination date shall be considered invalid and the results notice will not be accepted by PCN.		
6.4.9	The following process for unpaid exams shall be adopted by the AQB. • Grade the examination and raise a result notice as normal. • Do not submit any unpaid results notices to PCN. • Inform PCN (by way of email or letter) with a list of those on hold pending payment. • The candidate has 12 months, maximum, to pay for the examination taken or the examination results will become invalid and they will return to initial status. • When the candidate has met his/her financial commitments the AQB shall send results to PCN as normal indicating the reason for delay.		
6.4.10	BINDT reserves the right to require further evidence of competence before issuing a PCN certificate.		
6.5 Examination Records			
6.5.1	The AQB shall maintain examination records for all examinations conducted under its scope of approval. Examination records shall be retained for a period of not less than eleven years (see clause 4.2.9 previous). Examination records shall include the following, as a minimum: 1) Completed examination application forms and supporting evidence. 2) Completed BINDT forms:		

	• PCN24/PSL56A • PCN24/PSL56B (or equivalent) 3) Date of examination 4) Visual acuity and colour perception test record (current at time of examination) 5) All completed examination elements (general, specific, practical specimen reports, written instruction as applicable to the examination). 6) Marking schemes as detailed in PCN24/CP22 duly completed by the approved examiner 7) Copy of results notice. 8) Traceability to invigilator and examiner		
6.6 Remote Examinations			
6.6.1	The AQB may administer PCN examinations at Authorised Examination Centres (AECs) or other remote locations under the direct control of the AQB.		
6.6.2	An AEC is a location remote from the AQB where PCN examinations are administered on a regular basis. Such Examinations shall be carried out strictly in accordance with published requirements under the supervision of an approved invigilator who shall have direct access to an approved examiner should the need arise. All AECs must be approved by BINDT and the AQB should make advanced application for AEC approval. An examination centre may be situated at an employer's facility.		
6.6.3	All remote examinations, at AECs or other locations, remain the responsibility of the AQB in terms of process, security and impartiality.		
6.6.4	Remote Examinations are permitted under the conditions detailed in this section. <u>ALL</u> examinations conducted away from the AQB or AEC, <u>MUST</u> be authorised <u>IN ADVANCE</u> by BINDT. The controlling AQB is required to notify BINDT at least 7 days in advance of all instances where there is a proposal to conduct such remote examinations. Documented return permission/authorisation from BINDT is required before any such remote examinations can proceed. Failure to comply with this requirement may result in any non-authorised examinations being declared invalid by BINDT. Notification is the responsibility of the AQB who shall control the process even where AECs are involved. The AQB must inform the BINDT Certification Records Office by emailing them directly at pcn@bindt.org and must supply the following information:		

	• Name(s) of candidate(s). • Address of exam location • Company name (where appropriate) • Examination type Without this information PCN are not able to process any examination results due to the PCN database requirements. All results will be issued under the main AQB as usual.		
6.6.5	Where the AQB offers PCN examinations at one or more remote examination centres on a permanent or frequent basis, there shall be a documented procedure covering the conduct of examinations at each examination centre. This procedure shall address all of the requirements contained within this document and may be subject to audit on site at the discretion of BINDT, which shall approve all centres established for the conduct of PCN examinations.		
6.6.6	If the AQB intends to conduct 6 or more examination sessions (within a 12-month period) at a location, an application must be made to BINDT. This location can then be registered as an AEC prior to examinations being conducted. An AQB must apply to BINDT for an AEC location. It is the responsibility of all AQBs to ensure that all of their AECs fully conform to PCN24/CP09 requirements and are effectively controlled.		
6.6.7	The AQB shall conduct audits on all remote examination locations to ensure the following (as a minimum) conform to PCN24/CP09 requirements: • Facilities (Theory & Practical examination facilities) • Equipment (PCN24/CP09 minimum requirements) • Personnel • Impartiality and Security Arrangements • Health & Safety		
6.6.8	The AQB shall conduct audits at remote examination locations as follows: • Authorised Exam Centres (AEC) – minimum annually. • Remote Exam Centres (REC) – prior to each examination event. <i>BINDT Approved checklist PCN24/CP09B is available to assist in AEC/REC audits. These may be used or the AQB may generate their own checklists providing the required areas of PCN24/CP09 are addressed.</i>		
6.6.9	AQBs may conduct remote assessments of their AECs using video conferencing and other associated electronic measures and data capture/gathering capabilities.		

6.6.10	Remote assessments are permitted under the following conditions: • The AQB conducts such remote assessments in accordance with a detailed procedure and process. • At least one on-site assessment is conducted within the AQB's BINDT Approval cycle. Fully traceable reports and records are maintained for review at BINDT assessments – this includes all objective evidence captured by the AQB during the remote assessment		
6.6.11	BINDT monitors AQB control of its AECs through documentary review of the AQB records of audit on its AECs. This review is conducted during BINDT assessments at the AQB. BINDT reserves the right to witness AQB audits at their AECs.		
6.6.12	BINDT also now conducts AEC oversight assessments audits conducted by BINDT Lead assessors. These oversight assessments will normally be attached to scheduled Approved Training Organisation (ATO) audits and will be conducted upon completion of the ATO audit. The AEC assessment will normally be of one-half day duration but will depend finally upon the assessment progress. The AEC and controlling AQB shall make arrangements prior to the AEC assessment for examination records to be available to the auditor upon request. These records may be accepted in either hard or soft copy format and may be selected at random in advance of the assessment by the appointed lead auditor. The assessment will be conducted against the requirements of checklist PCN24/CP09B with any relevant requirements contained within PCN24/CP09 also being applied. This official BINDT oversight assessment does not absolve the controlling AQB from their audit responsibilities detailed above.		
6.6.13	Where examination material is stored at a location not under the constant supervision of AQB staff, e.g., at a site remote from any permanently established and staffed examination centre, the AQB shall notify BINDT Certification Services Division management of the location concerned, and the measures in place to safeguard the security and confidentiality of examination material. The AQB shall retain audit records of such locations which include ensuring that security of exam materials is adequately addressed. These audit records (including photographs, if required) shall be retained and made available at BINDT assessments. BINDT reserves the right to audit such storage facilities and to direct that specific additional measures be implemented to safeguard security and confidentiality.		

6.6.14	Where examination materials are transported between the AQB and the Remote location, the AQB shall have a documented process that details the actual materials transported and includes evidence of transport to/from each location. The AQB shall ensure the security of examination materials at all times while in transit or while retained at the remote location.		
6.6.15	Failure to comply with these requirements for remote examinations, especially with regard to audits and security, may result in the removal of AQB approval. BINDT takes very seriously any matters that may have potential to compromise the integrity and security of the PCN scheme.		
6.7 Examination Specimens for use at Authorised Examination Centres (AEC)			
6.7.1	The controlling AQB shall be responsible for ensuring that the number of specimens held by an AEC, or available on the day of any PCN examination event, is sufficient to ensure that no candidate, in that examination event is presented with any of the same examination specimens used by any other candidates during that same examination event.		
6.7.2	The AQB in conjunction with the AEC shall ensure that a sufficient number of specimens are available to verify that no candidates are presented with any of the same specimens at the next re-examination or re-certification event.		
6.7.3	Where examination specimens are the property of the AQB and stored at an AEC location, the AQB <u>SHALL</u> have a rotation plan in place, the rotation plan shall be documented within the AQB's Quality Management System QMS and made available to BINDT for review where requested.		
6.7.4	Where the specimens are the property of the AEC, the AEC shall relinquish <u>control</u> of the specimens to the AQB who shall assume all responsibilities associated with the specimens.		
6.7.5	Where the AEC is the <u>owner</u> of the examination specimens the AQB shall ensure that sufficient specimens are held at the AEC to satisfy clause 6.7.1 above.		
6.7.6	Where the AEC expects the number of candidates in any given examination event to exceed a number that renders the number of specimens held to be insufficient to meet clause 4.9.1, they shall notify the AQB who shall ensure that the minimum number of specimens available is sufficient to cater for the expected increased number of candidates.		

6.7.7	The AQB and AEC shall maintain traceable records to allow BINDT to establish verification and compliance with the requirements of this document, during scheduled BINDT audits.		
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